

# TWO WAYS OF CREATING PROMPTS

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## 1. Upfront Prompting

This way means you **write the full prompt at the beginning**. You put all the details, rules, and structure in one go, then run the agent. If something doesn't work, you edit the prompt and try again.

### ✓ Pros:

- Clear and detailed from the start.
- Great when you already know exactly what the agent must do.

### ✗ Cons:

- Harder to see what went wrong if the agent fails.
- Changing one part can break another part.
- Can easily become long and complicated.

### ★ Analogy:

It's like trying to build a whole house in one step - you draw all the rooms, wiring, and furniture before laying the first brick. If one design choice is wrong, fixing it later can be messy.

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## 2. Iterative Prompting

This way means you **start with a small, simple prompt** and then improve it step by step. You test the agent, look at what went wrong, and only then add the missing instructions.

### ✓ Pros:

- Easier to fix problems because you know exactly where they happened.
- Keeps prompts short and simple.
- Saves time because you only add what's really needed.

### ✗ Cons:

- Takes more testing in the beginning.
- Less predictable until the prompt is complete.

### ★ Analogy:

It's like building with Lego blocks. You start with a simple base, test if it stands, then add pieces one by one. Each step makes the structure stronger without guessing everything upfront.

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## Which Way Should You Use?

- Upfront Prompting is best when the task is clear, and you need a fixed, repeatable output.
- Iterative Prompting is best when you're experimenting, trying new tools, or not sure what rules the agent needs.

## My Recommendation

- Use Iterative Prompting every time you create prompts from scratch.
- Use Upfront Prompting when using AI to create prompts (we will cover it later in this section)